CVE Program Policy for Inactive CNAs

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Purpose and Scope

The effectiveness of the CVE Program's federated model depends on active CVE Numbering Authority (CNA) participation to preserve program coverage, accountability, and operational continuity.

This policy defines how the CVE Program identifies and addresses inactive CNAs. It is enforceable by CVE Program Roots, TL-Roots, and the Secretariat.

This policy applies to all CNAs operating under any Root within the CVE Program.

Inactive CNA Identification

A CNA is considered inactive when, over six months (or another period defined in writing by its TL-Root or Root), the CNA:

- Has not assigned or reserved CVE IDs within its scope; or
- Has not published any CVE Records within its scope; or
- Has not participated in working groups or discussions to advance CVE Program objectives; or
- Fails to respond to inquiries or requests from its Root, TL-Root, or the Secretariat.

The mere presence of reserved CVE IDs, if they have extraordinarily long disclosure timeframes, is not considered a sign of activity (see the CVE Reserved but Public (RBP) Policy).

Reasons for Inactivity

The CVE Program considers some reasons for inactivity to be valid, for instance, when no new vulnerabilities have been identified within the CNA's scope and normal assignment and publication activities resume once vulnerabilities are identified.

The CVE Program considers other reasons for inactivity to be invalid, for instance:

- When the CNA is no longer interested, properly resourced, or competent to participate in the CVE Program as a CNA.
- When the CNA's actions are detrimental to CVE Program objectives, for example, publishing vulnerability records exclusively through a platform outside of the CVE Program (such as a separate vulnerability information initiative).

CNAs that are inactive for valid reasons may continue to participate in the CVE Program. CNAs that are inactive for invalid reasons may not continue to participate, unless the reasons for inactivity are remediated to the satisfaction of the Root.

Identification and Engagement of Inactive CNAs

Roots and TL-Roots are responsible for identifying potentially inactive CNAs within their hierarchies and taking appropriate follow-up actions.

When a CNA appears to be inactive, the Root or TL-Root should:

1. Attempt to contact the CNA using the Administrative Point of Contact and any other available contact information to:
    - Confirm CNA communication status;
    - Determine the reason(s) for inactivity (valid or invalid); and
    - Discuss appropriate next steps, including remediation or possible decertification and removal from the program
2. Provide the CNA a reasonable timeframe (as defined by the TL-Root or Root) to respond and, if appropriate, to propose or implement corrective actions.

Decertified CNAs

A CNA that is decertified:

- Is no longer authorized to assign CVE IDs or publish CVE Records within a defined scope
- Will be removed from the CVE-Services, CNA-specific communications lists, and the List of Partners on the cve.org website.
- Any CVE IDs in the reserved state by the CNA will be returned to the CVE program and marked as “unused”.
- Will be mentioned in a public notification on the CVE.org website from the Root announcing the decertification along with the background and justification for the decertification.
- Will be announced to the CNA mailing list.

CNAs that are decertified are eligible to reapply to become a CNA in the future. They must complete the CNA onboarding process again and meet all current Program requirements.